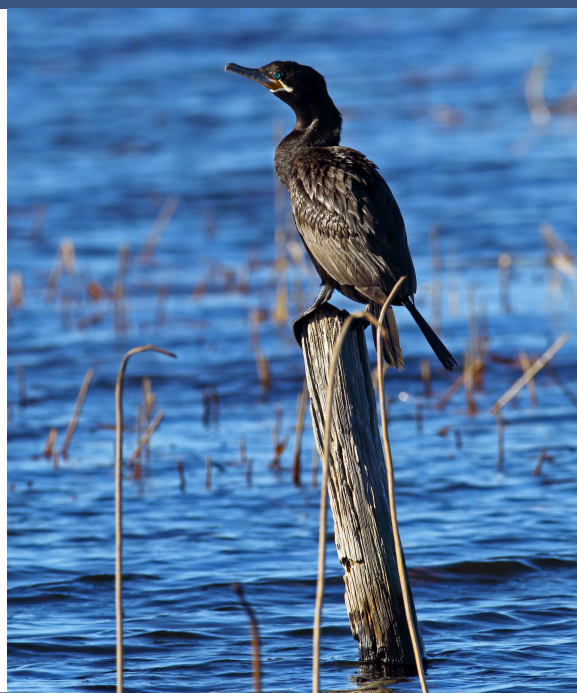


Neotropical Cormorant

Nannopterum brasilianum

Aquatic bird with shiny plumage

It is a species of aquatic bird that lives in fresh and salt water throughout America, from the southern United States to northern Chile and Argentina. This bird is easily recognizable by its shiny black plumage that, in the right light, can show a greenish or bluish hue. Its eyes are greenish blue and its beak is long and thin with a hook at the tip, adapted to catch fish. It measures between 60 and 75 centimeters.



A ritual of suntanning

The king of perfect tanning and sun drying! After catching fish and diving into the water, he can be seen on the shore with his wings spread out to dry. Unlike other aquatic birds, cormorants do not have highly developed sebaceous glands to waterproof their feathers, so it needs to dry in the sun in order to fly efficiently. This behavior makes him look like the star of the wetland!

Master of fishing!

The Neotropical cormorant is an expert predator in fishing, thanks to its agility and skills underwater. It uses a diving technique in which it submerges rapidly and pursues its prey, aided by its webbed feet. Its efficiency as a fisherman has caused conflicts with human fishermen, who consider it to be competing with them for the aquatic resources.



Health's indicator of aquatic ecosystems

Since it depends on the fish availability and water quality, the presence and abundance of Neotropical cormorants can be a sign of a balanced ecosystem. However, pollution, habitat destruction, and other factors related to human activity can negatively impact these birds and reduce their populations.

Symbol of adaptation

This bird is a fascinating example of adaptation to the environment and interaction with other species, including humans. In some cultures and regions, it has been the subject of myths and legends. Its ability to thrive in diverse habitats, from mangroves and rivers to estuaries and lakes, demonstrates its great adaptability. Observing and studying these birds not only contributes to the knowledge of local biodiversity, but also reinforces the importance of conserving its natural habitats.



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